

Celeste Frame

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

You discovered that Sterling knew the Star Bowl's provenance file contained a major gap and ordered the exhibition to proceed anyway. He threatened to remove you from the show if you raised the issue publicly.

What you are hiding

Against board instructions, you commissioned an independent provenance review and hid the preliminary report in the Registrar's Office. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Find out whether Marcus has seen the same gap you found.
- Learn who wrote the anonymous warning note.
- Keep your independent report secret until you decide whom to trust.

What you know about other guests

- Rafael told you Sterling pressured him to soften a conservation report.
- Marcus believes Sterling has suppressed provenance research connected to at least two Voss objects.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

You were in the Donor Salon at 6:25 correcting an object label. From 6:40 to 6:49, the Registrar's scanner log shows your curator code repeatedly scanning the independent provenance report you were not authorized to commission. Revealing the log clears your timing but exposes the report.

IF MURDERER

At 6:44 you used a label correction as an excuse to enter the Donor Salon. Believing Sterling was about to lock dubious objects permanently into the museum, you poisoned his cordial and returned to the gallery before anyone noticed.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card A. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card B. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I hid an independent provenance report because Sterling ordered me not to commission one. That was insubordination, not murder. The Registrar's scanner log shows me copying that report throughout the critical window. I was prepared to embarrass Sterling with evidence; I was not prepared to kill him for it.

IF MURDERER

Sterling knew exactly what the provenance file did not prove. He wanted my name on the label anyway so that scholarship could launder possession into legitimacy. I chose the moment he was alone, poisoned the cordial, and returned to the gallery. I told myself I was protecting the museum. I was really deciding that I knew better than the law.